Lab: Launch and Scale Planning

Objective

Design a comprehensive launch and scaling plan for your invention using Active Inference action selection principles. You will make deliberate choices about go-to-market strategy, distribution, pricing, and market entry approach, evaluating each action for both its epistemic value (what it teaches) and its pragmatic value (what it accomplishes).

Materials and Prerequisites

- Your invention concept, ecosystem map, stakeholder profiles, and strategic analysis from Modules 01-04
- Understanding of expected free energy and action selection from Section 1

Part 1: Go-to-Market Action Sequencing (15 minutes)

Step 1: State your invention and its current readiness level (concept, prototype, tested prototype, production-ready).

Write your response here

Step 2: Design a three-stage launch sequence. For each stage, specify the action, its primary purpose (epistemic vs. pragmatic), its target audience, and the evidence it will generate.

Stage	Action Description	Primary Purpose	Target Audience	Evidence Generated	Timeline
1 (Validation)					
2 (Establishment)					
3 (Scaling)					

Step 3: For Stage 1, what is the minimum action that would generate the highest-precision evidence about your most important assumption? (This is your launch MVP.)

Write your response here

Step 4: What positive prediction error should your launch create for customers? (How should the experience exceed the expectations you set?)

Write your response here

Step 5: What negative prediction error must you avoid? (What expectation must you not create that reality would disappoint?)

Write your response here

Part 2: Manufacturing and Production Strategy (10 minutes)

Step 1: Describe the production process for your invention (even if it is a service or digital product — describe the delivery infrastructure).

Write your response here

Step 2: Analyze the precision-flexibility trade-off for your production process.

Dimension	Current State (Prototype)	Target State (Scale)	Key Challenge in Transition
Output volume			
Unit cost			
Quality consistency			
Design flexibility			
Iteration speed			

Step 3: What is the biggest risk in scaling your production? What prediction error from Tesla's "production hell" or another manufacturing scaling case is most relevant to your situation?

Write your response here

Step 4: How will you maintain the ability to update your production process based on evidence after scaling? What is your equivalent of Toyota's "andon cord" or Zara's rapid iteration model?

Write your response here

Part 3: Distribution Channel Design (10 minutes)

Step 1: Evaluate three possible distribution channels for your invention.

Channel	Reach	Control	Cost	Signal Sent to Market	Fit with Your Strategy
Channel 1:					
Channel 2:					
Channel 3:					

Step 2: Select your primary distribution channel and explain why it provides the best combination of reach, control, and market signaling for your current stage.

Write your response here

Step 3: How might your distribution strategy evolve as you scale? What channels would you add at Stage 2 and Stage 3 of your launch sequence?

Write your response here

Part 4: Pricing Strategy (15 minutes)

Step 1: Analyze the pricing decision across four stakeholder perspectives.

Stakeholder	What price range would reduce their free energy?	What would too-high price signal?	What would too-low price signal?
Target Customer			
Investors			
Competitors			
Partners/ Distributors			

Step 2: Based on this multi-stakeholder analysis, select your initial pricing strategy.

Decision	Your Choice	Rationale
Price point		
Pricing model (subscription, one-time, freemium, usage-based)		
Initial discounting or promotional pricing?		
Price trajectory over time (increasing, decreasing, stable)		

Write your response here

Step 3: If you chose a freemium or trial model, describe the transition point — what must happen in the customer's generative model for them to be willing to pay?

Write your response here

Part 5: Market Entry Strategy (10 minutes)

Step 1: Evaluate three entry strategies for your market situation.

Strategy	Advantages for Your Invention	Disadvantages	Free Energy Implications
First Mover			
Fast Follower			
Niche Pioneer			

Step 2: Select your entry strategy and defend your choice with reference to your competitive position, resource constraints, and ecosystem phase.

Write your response here

Step 3: If you chose niche pioneer, define your initial niche. What makes this niche the right beachhead? How will you expand from it?

Write your response here

Step 4: What is the single most important action you should take in the next 30 days to advance your launch? Why this action above all others?

Write your response here

Discussion and Debrief

1. How did separating epistemic value from pragmatic value change your thinking about launch actions? Were there actions you initially planned for pragmatic reasons that should actually be designed for learning?
2. What is the most dangerous prediction error your launch could produce? How are you designing actions to prevent it?
3. Compare your pricing strategy with a peer's. How do different invention types and competitive contexts lead to different pricing approaches?
4. How does your market entry strategy account for competitor responses? What would you do if a well-funded competitor entered your niche within six months of your launch?
5. Looking at your three-stage launch sequence, what evidence at Stage 1 would cause you to abandon or radically modify Stages 2 and 3?